

Editorial
People Must Stand For
Consumer Rights

The decision of Johnson & Johnson to agree to pay nearly Rs.52,000 crore to petitioners who alleged that the company's talcum powder caused ovarian cancer is a significant reminder of the power of consumer awareness and legal action. The dispute has continued for decades, with thousands of affected consumers approaching the courts seeking justice. Though the company initially maintained that its talcum powder contained no substances capable of causing cancer, it later changed its product formula in 2020 by replacing talc with corn starch. While the company has continued to deny wrongdoing, the change in formulation itself has kept public debate alive.

One of the major reasons behind the settlement is believed to be the enormous legal expenses involved in defending thousands of lawsuits over many years. Whatever the legal outcome, the case has highlighted the importance of consumers questioning the safety of products they use every day and demanding accountability from manufacturers.

Unfortunately, such consumer activism is rarely witnessed in India. While people readily use a wide range of cosmetic and household products, very few come forward to question their safety or seek legal remedies when they suspect harm. Consumer rights remain one of the least discussed public issues despite their direct impact on health and well-being.

Environmentalists, consumer rights organizations, and public health activists should take the lead in creating greater awareness about product safety, health risks, and the legal rights available to consumers. Educational campaigns can encourage people to report harmful products and pursue legal action wherever necessary. Regulatory authorities must also strengthen product safety standards and ensure strict monitoring of items sold in the market.

The Johnson & Johnson episode should serve as a wake-up call. Consumers must remain informed, vigilant, and prepared to protect their rights. A society that values consumer awareness is better equipped to safeguard public health and ensure that companies remain accountable for the products they place in the hands of millions.

Editor

The Perils of "Demo-Crazy"
Why We Need More Iron Fists and Fewer Roof Tiles

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Ram Kamal

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Social Engineer

The recent kerfuffle in Delhi is a heartwarming reminder of the good old days—specifically, the iron-fisted glory of Indira Gandhi. Ah, the Emergency! I remember it fondly as a seventh grader back in Kerala. Back then, school was merely a 70-day side hustle; the rest of the academic year was generously dedicated to the vibrant extracurricular activity of strikes.

The Communist School of
Bus-Stoning and vandalisms

Back in those days, protests had standards. Communist labour workers would waltz into our school, command the Students Federation of India (SFI) members to halt all education by walking into a few classes and yell Sindabad. By that time, all students from all other classes would be out and their way home through the back gate of the school. These strikes only sent the poor kids into an existential dilemma. The teachers, absolutely thrilled at the prospect of a day off, would shoo their private tuition students home.

Then came the real vocational training: the comrades would dismantle the school's roof tiles, haul them to the front side MG Road boundary wall, and train toddlers in the ancient martial art of throwing masonry at passing buses. If the cops dared to intervene, the party bosses would pull some strings to keep the kids locked up just long enough to bail them out later, instantly transforming them into loyal, lifetime political goons with the Communist Party. In Kerala, both KSU, the Congress's student movement and AISF, the right-wing

communist gang and MSF, the Muslim League students' version. All these students' parties were made for this kind of STRIKE and Bandh games mentored by the trade union goons. That is how you build character for seasoned politicians those days!

Today's Incompetent Agitators

Fast forward to the recent Delhi episode. Today's so-called "students" agitating over NEET (who probably aren't even in the NEET age bracket) have absolutely no respect for these time-honoured traditions or the know-how. They lack the roof-tile training of the 70s. When someone makes a demand, they have the solution for the problem they are agitating. But these naive amateurs apparently do not have a solution for the NEET and other entrance examination corruption, and they have never taken such exams in their lives either. But they marched toward Parliament expecting the BJP government to roll out a red carpet, serve them tea, and politely hand over a cabinet minister's resignation letter. Instead, they found themselves trapped in a classic pincer movement. Police barricades blocked their front, while the real trained operatives of the opposition parties heroically hurled stones from behind them. Those visit this high-security area of Luten's Delhi can't find stones in the street for them to pick and throw. These seasoned players wearing backpacks pretending to be students carry stones and pepper sprays and bottles. Even a superintendent of police rescued



some of these students who got baffled seeing the violence, which was not in their script.

The Opposition's Grand Masterplan

You see, the opposition didn't just want a protest; they wanted a blockbuster tragedy. These masterminds boldly stepped to the front, pepper-spraying and beating the police. Their ultimate wish? To secure a dead body or two just to disrupt the parliament session and make India look like the chaotic streets of Nepal or Bangladesh. They were practically drooling at the thought of the Indian Prime Minister being manhandled like the Sri Lankan president. Naturally, the Leader of the Opposition (LoP) immediately crawled out of the woodwork to claim the government was destroying the youth, entirely ignoring the glorious history of the last ten years.

5D Chess and the Drone Armada

But the opposition severely underestimated the Supreme Leader. The Prime Minister wasn't just sitting there; he was exhibiting "greater patience" to execute a flawless masterstroke. He was simply baiting the puppet masters—the LoP, Kejriwal, and the so-called social activists- to step into the light. The game is simple now. This isn't the 1970s where you could just hide behind a communist or party labour union. No, we are in the era of satellites, drone surveillance, and Artificial Intelligence! Modiji, the very man who bravely eradicated foreign invaders with tit-for-tat strikes like Balakot and "Mission Sindoor," is currently booting up the AI to ensure these criminals pay a massive price. Even the guarantee given to protestors to end the CJP strike was no FIR against them does mean no FIR against the intruders. They will soon face the wrath of the new

Indian Nyaya Sanhita, which is vastly superior to those pesky, mad British rules. Footnote on the Real Enemy: Let us not forget that the true villains in all this are not the extremists or antinational elements. It is the entrance exam business mafia. I hope that if we can implement the majestic vision of the NEP 2020 and increase the number of professional institutions, we may find a solution for the entrance menace. Entrance question papers should be from the syllabus and should not be dictated by the coaching pundits. Do we need coaching or education? It is welcoming that the minister, Dharmendra Pradhan, resigned, showing the power of democratic values, and the invitation to Nandan Nilekani to reform the National Testing Agency and entrance exams is a step in the right direction. How long can lies get media space, and social media can play the DEMOCRAZY? Needs accountability and love for the nation.

Education Laws Need
Implementation, Not Just Promises

The future of students depends on accountability, transparency and effective execution of reforms

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India's education system stands at a critical crossroads. Despite decades of reforms, constitutional provisions, and ambitious policies, the gap between promises and implementation continues to widen. While the country has introduced several laws and frameworks aimed at transforming education, the lack of accountability, transparency and effective execution remains a major challenge.

The question today is not about the number of laws we have, but about how effectively they are implemented. The future of millions of students depends not merely on policies written on paper, but on the seriousness with which they are executed on the ground.

Even after nearly 78 years of independence, the education sector continues to struggle with deep contradictions.

On one side, we have constitutional amendments, the Right to Education (RTE) Act, 2009, the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, and several commissions and reforms. On the other side, issues such as examination paper leaks, teacher absenteeism, rote learning and lack of quality education continue to affect students.

The reality remains clear: making a law is easy, but ensuring its implementation is the real challenge.

The uncertainty surrounding the future of our children is not merely an education issue; it directly impacts the future of the nation.

How Many Laws? How Much Implementation?

After independence, India introduced several important educational reforms through commissions such as the University Education Commission (1948-49), Secondary Education Commission (1952-53), Kothari Commission (1964-66), National Education Policies of 1968, 1986 (amended in 1992) and 2020. Constitutional measures such as the 86th Amendment (2002), the RTE Act 2009, and regulatory bodies like AICTE and NCTE were also introduced.

These measures helped increase enrolment levels. However, the larger question remains — has quality education reached every child?

Reports such as ASER and PISA have repeatedly highlighted learning challenges. Many students can memorise textbooks but struggle to understand concepts, apply knowledge and develop essential skills.

Today, examination irregularities and paper leaks, including incidents related to major national-level examinations, have emerged as serious concerns. Despite cyber security measures and institutions



like the National Testing Agency (NTA), such incidents continue to raise questions about accountability.

This is not merely a technical failure. It reflects deeper issues of negligence, corruption and interference. A single examination leak can destroy the dreams of thousands of students, pushing some into extreme distress.

Instead of only announcing new regulations, the system requires strict action against negligence, fast-track investi-

gations, and continuous monitoring mechanisms.

Systemic Challenges Remain

The education sector continues to face several structural issues:

- Teacher quality, attendance problems and non-transparent appointments
- Digital divide affecting rural areas, economically weaker sections and girls
- Increasing coaching culture, financial burden and student stress

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- Political interference in universities and declining research standards
- Unemployment among graduates and increasing brain drain

As a result, education risks becoming a commercial activity rather than a powerful tool for social transformation.

What Does the Country Need Now?

Criticism alone cannot transform the system. The focus must shift towards mean-

ingful solutions:

1. Strong Accountability Mechanism:

Every education policy and law should have clear performance indicators, independent audits and strict action against failures. Examination systems should adopt advanced security measures, including AI-based monitoring, biometric verification and secure digital systems.

2. Effective Implementation of NEP 2020:

Teacher training, assess-

ment reforms and vocational education must reach rural areas to create meaningful opportunities for students.

3. Strengthening Teachers' Role:

Teachers must receive better salaries, continuous training and the respect required to shape future generations.

4. Transparency Through Technology:

Open data platforms, monitoring systems and independent regulatory mechanisms can improve trust in the education system.

5. Connecting Education With Life:

Education must be linked with employment, skills, innovation and civic responsibility while reducing the influence of money, politics and social divisions.

Introducing laws and announcing policies alone cannot transform education. Without implementation, accountability and responsibility, even the best reforms remain limited to documents.

The future of our children is the future of India. NEP 2020 provides a significant opportunity for change, but its success depends on honest implementation and collective responsibility.

The government, teachers, parents and students all have a role to play in rebuilding the education system.

Only by effectively harnessing the potential of India's youth can the vision of "Viksit Bharat 2047" become a reality. Otherwise, even with more laws and policies, the outcome will remain unchanged